



Summary of Key Person Interviews, Questions and List of Contacts

Copy of ORT Maintenance Statement
Copy of MTC Security and Operations Statement





**FRIENDS of the
RIVERFRONT**



**Ohio River Trail - Pittsburgh to Coraopolis
Key Interview List
Selected by Steering Committee - 20 total**

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------|
| 1. City of Pittsburgh | Pat Hassett |
| 2. Coraopolis | Dick Wolf (Bike Shop Owner) |
| 3. Kennedy Township | Anthony Mollica |
| 4. McKees Rocks | Jack Murh/Tricia Levander |
| 5. McKees Rocks Comm Dev. Corp | Taris Vrcek |
| 6. Trinity Development | Craig Rippole |
| 7. Neville Island | Rick Rutter |
| 8. Neville Island- Neville Green | Dorothy Antonelli |
| 9. PennDOT | Todd Kravitz |
| 10. Robinson Township | Samuel Abatta |
| 11. Stowe Township | Marie Incorvati |
| 12. Twp of Robinson- Montour Trail Security | Jesse Forquer |
| 13. West End of Pittsburgh Community (W.E. Village) | Theresa Kail-Smith |
| 14. Buncher Company | Brian Goetz, VP |
| 15. McKees Rocks Industrial | Jim Lind |
| 16. Zone 6 RE: Police Enforcement on W. Carson St. | |
| 17. West Carson Business Owner | Chuck Schneider |
| 18. Montour Industry Supply (Coraopolis) | Matt Ondrasik |
| 19. Stowe Block Watch | Brian Collosimo |
| 20. Bicycle Commuter | Bill Edmonds |

ADDITIONAL INTERVIEWS

21. City of Pittsburgh	Steve Patchen
22. Coraopolis	Ray McCutcheon
23. Allegheny County DPW	Dave Wright
24. Allegheny County DPW	Steven Johnson and Stephen Shanley
25. Neville Island	Dave Kerr
26. RMU	Don Smith
27. JMT	Lisa Cooper
28. AGF property owner, McKees Rocks Bottoms	Kim Perl
29. Cyclist interview on Fourth St. Coraopolis	Jim Flook
30. Resident Council Hays Manor	Isaiah Dent
31. Bike Pittsburgh	Scott Bricker



Ohio River Trail Feasibility Study
Municipalities Interview Questions
(Phone Interviews)

Written- June 4, 2012

- 1) What is your level of knowledge about the Project?
 - a) Have you received and reviewed the alignment maps? (*we intend to send them to them for their review prior to calling*)
- 2) *This is a Feasibility Study for a ped-bike system from Station Square to Coraopolis*
 - a) This is a 6-9 month project (May 2012-Jan 2013)
 - b) Our efforts are to review the alignment options for safety, security, mobility and functional use.
 - c) We will be having a follow-up field meeting in 2-3 weeks- are you interested in attending? If so, please provide your contact information via email (email to the callers email).
- 3) Do you have any questions about the document received or the study itself?
 - a) ...Any revisions to the alignment?
 - b) ...Do you have any issues with Safety and Security?
 - c) ...Land Ownership issues?
 - d) ...Other Alignments Opportunities to Connect the Community?
- 4) What is the (your organization's) (municipality's) level of support for an improved pedestrian and bicycle way through the community?
- 5) Do you know of or have past documents that would be helpful to this project?
 - a) Comprehensive plan
 - b) Greenway plan
 - c) Ped-bike improvement plan or ADA upgrades to sidewalks
 - i) Can you bring them to field meeting in 2-3 weeks?
- 6) Does the municipality (or private owner) own land near or adjacent to the alignments or as a potential connection to the waterways?
- 7) (MAY SKIP IF N/A)- Does your organization (municipality) have any upcoming Capital Improvement Projects in the Alignment?
 - a) Utility relocation/repairs- Authority Contact?
 - b) Roadway widening, road repairs
 - c) Sidewalk replacement, repairs
 - d) Signal and crossing updates; ADA compliance updates
 - i) Could any of your current capital projects, in the alignment, include:
 - (1) widening for a paved shoulder

- (2) a "road diet" (restriping of the existing road to allow for a 4' wide bike lane on each side)
- 8) (MUNICIPAL Q)- Who owns the sidewalks along the alignment?
a) Who maintains sidewalks along alignment?
- 9) (ONLY FOR Railroad Areas)- (City of Pgh, Kennedy, Esplen, McKees R, Stowe) Do you have any contacts with the RR?
- 10) Do you have available personnel and equipment to support maintenance and operation for improved ped-bike system?
a) List kinds of Equipment? (street sweeper, backhoe, line painter?)
- 11) Are you interested in a possible Bicycle Commission (volunteers appointed by council) to operate and maintain system?
- 12) ...Knowledge of other organizations that may want to get involved?
a) Operations
b) Maintenance
c) Safety-Security
d) Grant Writing
e) Fundraising
f) Events to raise Awareness and Funding Support
- 13) What phone number and email could we use to stay in touch with you about future meetings, and draft plan reviews?

MTC Security Policy

1.0 Mission Statement:

In 1998 the Montour Trail Council (MTC) recruited and organized a group of civilian patrols to patrol the Montour Trail. The clear mission of the volunteers engaged in the "Trail Monitor Patrol Program" then and now has been to provide help to trail users in case of emergencies. The trail monitors also serve to provide surveillance of the Montour Trail and its parking areas. Another part of the mission of trail monitor patrols is to establish a presence on the trail. The MTC believes that the establishment of this presence by the patrols sends a strong message to anyone looking to cause problems, which is "not in our backyard".

2.0 Trail Monitor Patrol Program Mission

The most important mission of a trail monitor patrol (trail monitor) is to assist in the event of emergencies. Further, an emergency could be defined as a situation when anyone is experiencing physical distress requiring medical help or protection from harassment. An emergency can also be defined as any situation where an incident is occurring that creates a dangerous condition to the safety of our trail users or the trail monitor. If any emergency arises trail monitors are to dial 911, give their location, describe the situation and request emergency help.

The MTC in no way is suggesting that trail monitors put themselves at personal risk at any time. Trail monitors are not law enforcement. Their function is to provide another layer of surveillance. If, for example, an altercation of harassment involving physical threats were to occur, a trail monitor is to exit the area to a safe location and then dial 911.

2.1 Trail Monitor Training and Instructions

We strongly encourage all trail monitors to take the American Heart Association or Red Cross Program Course for First Aid/ CPR/ AED and to maintain current certification. However, it is a personal decision whether to perform CPR. For those who chose to perform CPR make sure consent is obtained if possible per the recommendations of the American Heart Association or the American Red Cross Manuals. The procedures in their manuals should be followed in every respect. Particular attention should be given to wearing surgical gloves if any blood is encountered and wearing face shields if resuscitation is to be performed.

2.2 Reporting incidents

After an emergency is dealt with it should then be reported to the Director of Trail Security via email or telephone. The necessary contact information is in Appendix A. Incidents reported will be compiled and incorporated into the Trail Security Report given to the Board of Directors each month.

2.3 Trail Monitor Comportment

A trail monitor will create a presence of the MTC to trail users. Anyone who serves in this group will monitor trail activity during their own regular trail use. A trail monitor will not be expected to patrol on any imposed schedule. The trail monitors will report any emergencies to the local police or ambulance authority (dial 911) and trail deficiencies in a timely manner.

- A trail monitor should conduct themselves in such a way to let trail users know of their presence and that help is there if an emergency might occur.
- A trail monitor should familiarize themselves with and politely remind trail users to obey the trail rules. See Appendix B for official trail rules.
- A trail monitor should attempt to greet, smile and make eye contact with everyone who passes in order to create a relationship between the MTC and trail users.
- Trail monitors should familiarize themselves with the trail map and be prepared to give directions to trail users when asked.
- Trail monitors are ambassadors for the Montour Trail Council and should be polite to trail users at all times.

2.4 Trail Monitor Equipment:

Each trail monitor shall be given a gate key. Patrols are expected to wear bright “Trail Monitor Patrol” tee shirts or vests to identify themselves to trail users.

3.0 Duties of the Director of Trail Security:

The Director of Trail Security reports directly to the Montour Trail Board of Directors, and has duties as follows:

1. Prepare a monthly consolidated security report for the MTC Board of Directors meeting.
2. Provide oversight, supervision, recruiting and training of trail monitors. This duty is shared with the emergency contacts listed in Appendix A.
3. Maintain a database with contact information of all trail monitors in cooperation with the MTC membership chair and Emergency contacts shall provide all contact information for new Patrols to the Director of Security for inclusion in the “Trail Monitor Patrol Data Base”.
4. Work in cooperation with the emergency contacts listed in Appendix A to offer any assistance required on request.
5. Acts as the 911 liaison with both Washington and Allegheny Counties, providing them with whatever information (updated maps, etc.) they need to be able to respond effectively to trail emergencies.

Appendix A: Director of Trail Security & Emergency Contact Information

Jesse J. Forquer
60 Eichelberger Drive
Coraopolis, Pa 15108

Home Phone: 412 859-3737
Cell Phone: 412 897-9256
e-mail: jjforquer@comcast.net

Security contacts are as follows for these municipalities:

Moon, Robinson and Findlay Townships:
Cecil and Mt. Pleasant Townships:
Peters Township:
Bethel Park Borough:
South Park Township & City of Clairton:

Jesse Forquer
Dennis Sims
Mark Imgrund or his appointee
Peter Kohnke or his appointee
Paul McKeown or his appointee

Appendix B: Official Trail Rules

1. No Motorized Vehicles
2. Keep Right, Except to Pass
3. Warn Before Passing
4. Stay on Trail
5. Trail Open Daily, Dawn to Dusk
6. No Fires or Camping
7. Leash Your Pet
8. No Hunting

Appendix C: Trail Monitor Questionnaire

TRAIL MONITOR QUESTIONNAIRE

NAME AND ADDRESS

PHONE NUMBER(s)

E-MAIL ADDRESS

**DO YOU HAVE A CELL PHONE? IF YES, COULD YOU CARRY IT
WHEN ON THE TRAIL?**

ARE YOU A RUNNER, WALKER OR BIKER ?

HOW MANY TIMES A WEEK ARE YOU USUALLY ON THE TRAIL ?

BETWEEN WHAT HOURS ?

**BETWEEN WHAT MILE MARKS ARE YOU NORMALLY ON THE
TRAIL?**

**DO YOU KNOW ANYONE ELSE THAT WOULD BE INTERESTED IN OUR TRAIL
MONITOR'S PROGRAM?**

**Do you have a police record for anything other than traffic
Violations ?**

Would you object if we did a background check on you ?

**I hereby agree to abide by the MTC Security Policy & return any materials given to
me upon request of a representative of the Montour Trail:**

Signature of Applicant



1100 Pennsylvania Av
Monaca, Pa 15061
www.ohiorivertrail.org

Phone: 724.728.2625
Fax: 724.775.9876
drvtroia@ohiorivertrail.org

Ohio River Trail Council

"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

Ohio River Trail Maintenance Policy

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) shall manage and administer the operation and management of the Ohio River Trail pursuant to this policy in conjunction with each municipality (Participant).

- (1) **Ownership** – The Participant retains ownership of its portion of the Ohio River Trail within its municipality limits.
- (2) **Grants** – The ORTC in partnership with all or some of the Participants, will pursue grant funding for the cyclic costs and all capital improvements.
- (3) **Planning** – The ORTC shall be responsible for all planning related to the operation and management of the trail. The ORTC shall involve the Participants in the planning process.
- (4) **Directing** – The ORTC shall be responsible for directing the operations of the trail through coordination with the Participants. This includes:
 - a. Development and establishment of planned maintenance management system for the Ohio River Trail.
 - b. Scheduling and implementation of seasonal trail cleanup programs.
 - c. Inspecting the trail at regular intervals and coordinating any maintenance needs with the respective Participant.
 - d. Contracting for high tree pruning and herbicide spraying.
 - e. Replacement of equipment.
 - f. Contracting for any repair that is "capital" in size and scope.
 - g. Serving as the single point of contact for the trail and responding to all citizen concerns and requests for information.
 - h. Coordinating the development of volunteer training.
 - i. Developing and implementing a trail volunteer program.
 - j. Responding to requests for assistance from the Participants regarding trail operations.
 - k. The ORTC will be responsible for soliciting and entering into contracts for trail resurfacing.
- (5) **Evaluating** – The ORTC shall be responsible for annually evaluating trail operations in collaboration with the Participants and making recommendations on operational improvements.
- (6) **Communication** – Each participant shall inform the ORTC about the trail with respect to conditions or incidents that require ORTC response. Identify and report the trail needs of their respective municipality to the ORTC, as well as monitoring the progress of the ORTC in addressing those needs. Each participant shall designate an official contact for the Ohio River Trail for communication with the ORTC and attend ORTC Meetings.
- (7) **Insurance** – The ORTC shall purchase liability insurance for the Ohio River Trail.

Greenways

Blueways

ORT Field View 8.16.12 at 2pm

Visited Coraopolis, Fourth Avenue and Fifth Avenue- Bicycle PA Route-A alignments.

Interviewed cyclist on Fourth Ave. heading west-

Mr. Jim Flook (jflook218@comcast.net)

Jim rides Bicycle PA Route-A from Aliquippa to Pgh and other routes in the river valley, including the Montour Trail. He commented that the Coraopolis ride (4th and 5th Ave) was not bad at all (including traffic speed and volume), but the shoulder condition west of Coraopolis is terrible- he has to ride on the road; on these roads the auto speeds increase.

He wanted to know how the new alignment would connect to Pgh, and was interested in the Neville Route, he currently rides through the hills along BikePA Route-A (between Coraopolis and McKees Rocks).

Jim was interested in the project and receiving information about the outcome.

signed: RWG